

Chapter 71 Part 10

Today Su Meiqi was like a cat with its fur standing on end. She probably wanted to find an excuse to move out of the house.

Zhou Yi'an glanced upstairs, then lowered her head to eat.

Su Yao didn't have much energy. She ate a little at random and then returned to her room to rest. But before going back to her room, she said to Su Zhe: "Don't say those hurtful things to Qiqi. She's already obedient enough. Your temper is too bad. You always put her down."

Su Zhe waved his hand. "Alright, go back to your room and rest. I'll think about it."

"If she doesn't want to enter the company, let Su Nan¹ do it." Su Yao said: "Why is Su Nan's dream a dream, but Qiqi has to give way to him?"

Su Zhe frowned: "If either of these two was willing to enter the company, would I need to do this?"

Su Yao sighed: "Anyway, don't push Qiqi too hard."

Su Zhe said impatiently: "I know."

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After dinner, Zhou Yi'an held Sheng Yu on the sofa and played with her for a while. Then, thinking of what happened during the day, she directed Sheng Yu to deliver cake to Su Meiqi, who hadn't eaten her fill. She called Su Zhe to the study.

As soon as they entered, Su Zhe spoke: "You don't need to plead for Qiqi. Her temper is getting worse now. She needs to be disciplined, or sooner or later she'll cause real trouble."

"That's not it." When facing elders, Zhou Yi'an's attitude was also very gentle. She said in a low voice: "I'm looking for you to understand something else."

"What is it?" Su Zhe asked.

Zhou Yi'an paused, then still asked: "Do you know that Teacher Su has another daughter?"

Su Zhe frowned. "Isn't it just Sheng Yu?"

"No." Zhou Yi'an said: "The one from the Sheng family, who now has the surname Xu."

Hearing this, Su Zhe's expression immediately changed. He sneered: "I know. What about it?"

Zhou Yi'an said: "Why back then..."

"Keep this matter to yourself." Su Zhe interrupted her. "This child has had the surname Xu for so many years. Are we supposed to have her change it to Sheng now? Speaking of which, Xu Guangyao is black-hearted enough. He didn't even leave the Sheng family's last bit of bloodline—made her take the surname Xu directly. Those two old things fought over her for so long for nothing."

"Fought?" Zhou Yi'an frowned: "So Xu Qingzhu was snatched away by the Sheng family?"

When Su Zhe talked about this matter, his anger rose. He picked up the cold tea on the table and drank it all in one gulp, but was still agitated: "What else? If it weren't for those two old things, would my sister have become like this? Damn it."

Su Zhe was so angry he cursed. "Did my sister kill their son? It was a natural disaster, an act of God. Who could have prevented it? But they came over to scold my sister and snatch the child. Damn it. Su Yao had just finished her postpartum confinement²."

When Su Zhe said this, his anger made his teeth itch and his voice tremble, showing how deep the grudge was.

Zhou Yi'an consoled him at the right time: "Calm down, don't get too worked up."

Su Zhe poured himself another cup of cold tea, trying to cool down the fire in his heart. "I've been holding it in all these years. If it weren't for the fact that my sister's daughter is still there, I would have already brought down Minghui³. What trash."

Zhou Yi'an: "..."

Su Zhe let out a light breath. "That girl is quite capable. Have you met her?"

"Mm." Zhou Yi'an said: "We've run into each other a few times. She looks more like Sheng Qinglin, not much like Teacher Su."

So at the time, Zhou Yi'an hadn't connected her with Su Yao.

It was only later when investigating Xu Qingzhu that she traced it back to Su Yao.

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What enemies they were.

"You become like whoever feeds you." Su Zhe said through gritted teeth: "Last time I saw her, I felt she looked a lot like Sheng Linlang⁴."

Zhou Yi'an smiled. "Don't be angry anymore. It's been so many years."

"Even though it's been so many years, when I think about it, I still want to go to the Sheng family's door and curse them out." Su Zhe sneered: "That shows you how much I hate them. Su Yao had just finished postpartum confinement, and Sheng Qinglin was going to propose to her. He died on the road."

Su Zhe's hands were trembling. "Su Yao was standing right across the street. She watched Sheng Qinglin get hit and killed right in front of her eyes. She was completely dazed."

"They were abroad at the time. The Sheng family rushed over overnight—just those two. When my sister went to their house, they thought she was wonderful in every way. But as soon as their son had an accident, those two changed completely. Su Yao was scared stupid, just crying the whole time. When I got there..."

Su Zhe paused, choking up at the memory. "Su Yao's eyes were so red, like she was going blind. Her daughter was crying in the hospital room too. She was crying. The Sheng family was powerful then. They brought people to snatch the daughter. Su Yao fought with them."

Recalling that scene, Su Zhe couldn't help but redden his eyes.

He watched his own sister, whom he had cherished and loved, kneeling on the ground. Next to her was Sheng Qinglin's body, just covered with a white cloth. She cried and begged the Sheng family couple to return her daughter to her. But those two said this was Sheng Qinglin's only flesh and blood in this world and must return to the Sheng family.

Su Yao cried and said she would have a ghost marriage⁵ with Sheng Qinglin.

That proud person, she bowed down for her daughter, saying she was willing to remain a widow for life, just wanting to keep her only daughter with Sheng Qinglin.

But the Sheng family couple called her unlucky. They said if it weren't for her, their son wouldn't have died.

So they only wanted the daughter, not Su Yao.

Su Zhe had wanted to throw punches at the time, but was no match for the Sheng family's power. He was held back by people.

In the hospital room were the intermingled wails of Su Yao and the child.

The Sheng family snatched away Su Yao's daughter right in front of Sheng Qinglin's corpse, then transported Sheng Qinglin's body back to the country. When they held the funeral, they also barred Su Yao from entering.

Footnotes:

¹ Su Nan (蘇南): Su Meiqi's cousin, mentioned in passing. The name literally means "Su South."

² Postpartum confinement (月子, yuèzi): A traditional Chinese practice where new mothers rest for about 30-40 days after giving birth, following specific dietary and lifestyle restrictions to aid recovery. This period is considered crucial for the mother's health.

³ Minghui (明輝): Refers to Minghui Technology, the Xu family's company that was mentioned earlier in the story.

⁴ Sheng Linlang (盛琳琅): Sheng Qinglin's mother, Xu Qingzhu's paternal grandmother.

⁵ Ghost marriage (冥婚, míng hūn): A traditional Chinese practice where a living person "marries" a deceased person, or two deceased people are married to each other. It's done to fulfill filial obligations or ensure the deceased has companionship in the afterlife. In this context, Su Yao was desperately offering to perform this ritual to stay connected to the Sheng family and keep her daughter.